

D199

# Introduction to Physical and Human Geography

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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# How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | _____  |                               |

# Items

1.

In a mountainous region famous for its tea and colorful festivals, farmers cut terraces into steep hillsides to create flat fields and slow soil erosion. The region's largest town has about 40,000 residents. Which theme of geography does the terracing best illustrate?

- A. Place.
- B. Human-environment interaction.
- C. Movement.
- D. Location.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

2.

A travel guide for a coastal city known for its seafood markets describes the city as being at 36.8° S, 174.8° E, and also as about a three-hour drive north of a large volcanic lake. The city hosts a yearly sailing race. Which description gives its absolute location?

- A. A coastal city known for seafood markets.
- B. About a three-hour drive north of a large volcanic lake.
- C. Both descriptions are absolute because both are precise.
- D. 36.8° S, 174.8° E.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

3.

A study maps the area where a single city's daily newspaper is delivered, which stretches along the highways leading out of the city. The city has a famous minor-league baseball team and a historic riverfront. What type of region is the delivery area?

- A. Perceptual region.
- B. A formal region, because every home receives the same paper.
- C. Functional region.
- D. Formal region.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of a perceptual (vernacular) region?

- A. "The Deep South," whose borders people describe differently.
- B. Any region that has a name.
- C. The commuting area around a major airport hub.
- D. A country where a single official language is spoken throughout.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

5.

A family in a rural village known for weaving decides to move to a large coastal city. They say the city has many factory jobs and a well-regarded public hospital. The family owns two goats and a small orchard. Which factor in their decision is a pull factor?

- A. Factory jobs in the city.
- B. Poor harvests in the village.
- C. Their ownership of goats and an orchard.
- D. The distance and cost of the trip.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of the following is a push factor for migration?

- A. Relatives already living in the destination city.
- B. A mountain range between origin and destination.
- C. High wages in a neighboring country.
- D. A multi-year drought that ruins crops in the home region.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

7.

Fleeing armed conflict in their home province, a family known for their pottery travels 300 kilometers to a camp in another province of the same country. They left behind a small shop and carried a family photo album. Which term best describes them?

- A. Refugees.
- B. Refugees, because they traveled more than 100 kilometers.
- C. Internally displaced persons.
- D. Economic migrants.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

8.

A country with a crude birth rate of 32 per 1,000 and a crude death rate of 8 per 1,000 is also famous for its mountain railways. Net in-migration adds another 3 per 1,000 each year. Based on natural increase, about how many years will its population take to double?

- A. About 17.5 years.
- B. About 2.9 years.
- C. About 29 years.
- D. About 26 years.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A country's population is doubling about every 35 years from natural increase alone. Its crude death rate is 10 per 1,000. What is its crude birth rate?

- A. 20 per 1,000
- B. 30 per 1,000
- C. –10 per 1,000
- D. 12 per 1,000

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

10.

A city known for its jazz clubs and river cruises had its coldest January in 15 years. A local commentator says this shows the planet is not warming. Global average temperatures have risen over recent decades. What is the best response?

- A. Climate is the same as the average weather of one season.
- B. A single cold month is weather; climate is judged from long-term averages over decades.
- C. The commentator is right because the cold was the worst in 15 years.
- D. Cold weather can never happen in a warming climate.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

11.

A coastal town with a popular summer fish festival builds a higher seawall and raises roads to cope with more frequent flooding from sea level rise. The town council has seven members. Which kind of climate response is this?

- A. Adaptation.
- B. Mitigation, because it is a climate-related project.
- C. Neither, because it does not change the global climate.
- D. Mitigation.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which action is an example of climate mitigation?

- A. Planting drought-tolerant crop varieties.
- B. Building homes on stilts in flood zones.
- C. Opening cooling centers during heat waves.
- D. Replacing a coal power plant with solar and wind generation.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer B Concept 1

In a mountainous region ~~famous for its tea and colorful festivals~~, farmers cut terraces into steep hillsides to create flat fields and slow soil erosion. ~~The region's largest town has about 40,000 residents.~~ Which theme of geography does the terracing best illustrate?

**Target word:** theme **Decides:** People reshaping land to meet their needs.

|          |                   |                                                                                             |
|----------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Camouflage        | Answers the tea and festival details that describe the area's character, not the terracing. |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Terracing modifies the physical environment for farming.                                    |
| C        | Confusion set     | Movement is the flow of people, goods, or ideas.                                            |
| D        | Adjacent category | Location answers where, not how people change the land.                                     |

## 2. Answer D Concept 2

A travel guide for a coastal city ~~known for its seafood markets~~ describes the city as being at 36.8° S, 174.8° E, and also as about a three-hour drive north of a large volcanic lake. ~~The city hosts a yearly sailing race.~~ Which description gives its absolute location?

**Target word:** absolute location **Decides:** Latitude and longitude.

|          |                   |                                                                     |
|----------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category | Describes character, which is place, not location.                  |
| B        | Confusion set     | Describing position relative to another place is relative location. |
| C        | Absolute language | Precision does not make a description absolute; coordinates do.     |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Coordinates give a fixed absolute position.                         |

## 3. Answer C Concept 3

A study maps the area where a single city's daily newspaper is delivered, which stretches along the highways leading out of the city. ~~The city has a famous minor league baseball team and a historic riverfront.~~ What type of region is the delivery area?

**Target word:** region type **Decides:** Organized around a central node and its connections.

|          |                    |                                                                                        |
|----------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set      | Perceptual regions exist in people's shared images, not delivery routes.               |
| B        | Inverted operation | The shared paper comes from the hub; the pattern is defined by connection to the node. |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | The area is defined by links to a central city.                                        |
| D        | Adjacent category  | Formal regions share a uniform trait, not ties to a hub.                               |

## 4. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

Which is an example of a perceptual (vernacular) region?

**Target word:** reverse: example from type **Decides:** Defined by people's shared sense of place.

|          |                   |                                                                          |
|----------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Perceptual regions are defined by popular perception with fuzzy borders. |
| B        | Absolute language | Formal and functional regions also have names.                           |
| C        | Confusion set     | A hub and its connections define a functional region.                    |
| D        | Adjacent category | A uniform, measurable trait makes a formal region.                       |

## 5. Answer A Concept 4

A family in a rural village ~~known for weaving~~ decides to move to a large coastal city. They say the city has many factory jobs and a well-regarded public hospital. ~~The family owns two goats and a small orchard.~~ Which factor in their decision is a pull factor?

**Target word:** pull factor **Decides:** Attraction at the destination.

|   |                    |                                                                      |
|---|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | A benefit at the destination is a pull factor.                       |
| B | Inverted operation | A problem at the origin is a push factor, and it is not in the stem. |
| C | Camouflage         | Their possessions in the village are not a pull toward the city.     |
| D | Adjacent category  | That is an intervening obstacle.                                     |

## 6. Answer D Concept 4 · transfer

Which of the following is a push factor for migration?

**Target word:** reverse: push factor **Decides:** Condition at the origin driving people away.

|   |                    |                                                    |
|---|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| A | Confusion set      | Family networks at the destination pull migrants.  |
| B | Adjacent category  | That is an intervening obstacle.                   |
| C | Inverted operation | Destination attractions are pull factors.          |
| D | <b>Correct</b>     | A harsh condition at the origin pushes people out. |

## 7. Answer C Concept 5

Fleeing armed conflict in their home province, a family ~~known for their pottery~~ travels 300 kilometers to a camp in another province of the same country. ~~They left behind a small shop and carried a family photo album.~~ Which term best describes them?

**Target word:** migrant category **Decides:** Forced to flee but did not cross an international border.

|   |                   |                                                                  |
|---|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Confusion set     | Refugee status requires crossing an international border.        |
| B | Wrong stem number | Distance does not define refugee status; crossing a border does. |
| C | <b>Correct</b>    | They fled conflict but stayed within their own country.          |
| D | Adjacent category | Economic migrants move voluntarily for work.                     |

## 8. Answer C Concept 6

A country with a crude birth rate of 32 per 1,000 and a crude death rate of 8 per 1,000 ~~is also famous for its mountain railways. Net in migration adds another 3 per 1,000 each year.~~ Based on natural increase, about how many years will its population take to double?

**Target word:** doubling time **Decides:**  $RNI = (32 - 8) / 10 = 2.4\%$ ;  $70 / 2.4$ .

|   |                    |                                                                  |
|---|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Inverted operation | Adds the death rate to the birth rate instead of subtracting it. |
| B | Dropped element    | Divides 70 by 24 without converting per 1,000 to percent.        |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | $RNI = 2.4\%$ ; $70 / 2.4 \approx 29$ years.                     |
| D | Camouflage         | Adds migration, which is not part of natural increase.           |

### 9. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A country's population is doubling about every 35 years from natural increase alone. Its crude death rate is 10 per 1,000. What is its crude birth rate?

**Target word:** solve for birth rate **Decides:**  $RNI = 70 / 35 = 2\% = 20$  per 1,000;  $CBR = 20 + 10$ .

|          |                    |                                                            |
|----------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Dropped element    | Stops at natural increase and does not add the death rate. |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | $2\% = 20$ per 1,000; $20 + 10 = 30$ .                     |
| C        | Inverted operation | Subtracts natural increase from the death rate.            |
| D        | Confusion set      | Adds 2 without converting the percent to per 1,000.        |

### 10. Answer B Concept 7

A city ~~known for its jazz clubs and river cruises~~ had its coldest January in 15 years. A local commentator says this shows the planet is not warming. Global average temperatures have risen over recent decades. What is the best response?

**Target word:** weather vs. climate **Decides:** One cold month is weather, not the long-term climate pattern.

|          |                   |                                                                          |
|----------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set     | Confuses a short period with the long-term pattern.                      |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Climate trends are measured over about 30 years or more.                 |
| C        | Wrong stem number | 15 years in one city is still too short and too local to define climate. |
| D        | Absolute language | Variability continues within long-term warming.                          |

### 11. Answer A Concept 8

A coastal town ~~with a popular summer fish festival~~ builds a higher seawall and raises roads to cope with more frequent flooding from sea level rise. ~~The town council has seven members.~~ Which kind of climate response is this?

**Target word:** response type **Decides:** Coping with impacts, not reducing emissions.

|          |                   |                                                                          |
|----------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | The seawall adjusts to climate impacts.                                  |
| B        | Absolute language | Not every climate action is mitigation.                                  |
| C        | Dropped element   | Adaptation does not need to change the climate; it reduces harm from it. |
| D        | Confusion set     | Mitigation reduces greenhouse gas emissions or adds carbon sinks.        |

### 12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

Which action is an example of climate mitigation?

**Target word:** reverse: pick mitigation **Decides:** Reduces emissions or captures carbon.

|          |                    |                                            |
|----------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| A        | Inverted operation | Coping with drought impacts is adaptation. |
| B        | Confusion set      | Adjusting to flood risk is adaptation.     |
| C        | Adjacent category  | Protecting people from heat is adaptation. |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Cutting emissions addresses the cause.     |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | <b>Right</b>                                          | <b>Wrong</b>                                                                          |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| <b>Trap</b>        | <b>What it does</b>                                          | <b>In this drill</b> | <b>Your misses</b> |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 3                    |                    |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 2                    |                    |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 8                    |                    |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 6                    |                    |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 4                    |                    |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 10                   |                    |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 3                    |                    |

# Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                                   | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Trap                                                                                            | Tell                                                                                          |
|---|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Five themes of geography</b>           | Location (where), place (physical and human character), human-environment interaction (how people change and adapt to the environment), movement (people, goods, ideas), and region (areas grouped by shared traits).                                                                | Labeling any description of a landscape as “place” even when it shows people reshaping it.      | A verb describing people modifying, depending on, or adapting to land, water, or climate.     |
| 2 | <b>Absolute vs. relative location</b>     | Absolute location is a fixed position, such as latitude and longitude or a street address; relative location describes position in relation to other places.                                                                                                                         | Calling a description like “two hours north of the capital” absolute because it is precise.     | Coordinates vs. a reference to another place.                                                 |
| 3 | <b>Types of regions</b>                   | A formal region shares a measurable trait throughout (a language, a climate); a functional region is organized around a central node and its connections (a commuting zone, a TV market); a perceptual (vernacular) region exists in people's shared sense of place (“the Midwest”). | Calling any named region formal.                                                                | Whether the region is defined by a uniform trait, a hub and its links, or popular perception. |
| 4 | <b>Push and pull factors</b>              | Push factors drive people away from an origin (conflict, drought, unemployment); pull factors attract them to a destination (jobs, safety, family); intervening obstacles lie between.                                                                                               | Swapping push and pull by focusing on whether the factor is good or bad instead of where it is. | A condition described at the origin or at the destination.                                    |
| 5 | <b>Categories of migrants</b>             | A refugee has crossed an international border to flee persecution or conflict; an internally displaced person fled but stayed within their own country; an economic migrant moves voluntarily for work or income.                                                                    | Calling anyone forced to flee a refugee, even without crossing a border.                        | Whether a border was crossed and whether the move was forced.                                 |
| 6 | <b>Natural increase and doubling time</b> | Rate of natural increase (%) = (crude birth rate – crude death rate) / 10, using rates per 1,000; doubling time $\approx 70 / \text{RNI}$ in percent. Migration is not part of natural increase.                                                                                     | Forgetting to convert per 1,000 to percent, or adding migration.                                | Birth and death rates per 1,000 people.                                                       |

| # | Concept                                  | Rule                                                                                                                                                                                       | Trap                                                        | Tell                                                       |
|---|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7 | <b>Weather vs. climate</b>               | Weather is short-term atmospheric conditions; climate is the long-term pattern, typically averaged over about 30 years. A single cold spell does not disprove a warming climate.           | Using one season or event as evidence about climate change. | A claim about climate based on a short time span.          |
| 8 | <b>Climate mitigation vs. adaptation</b> | Mitigation reduces the causes of climate change (cutting greenhouse gas emissions, adding carbon sinks); adaptation adjusts to its effects (seawalls, heat plans, drought-tolerant crops). | Calling any climate-related action mitigation.              | Whether the action lowers emissions or copes with impacts. |

**Course scope (public description):** This is Introduction to Physical and Human Geography, a three-module course that addresses the question of what geography really is in today's complex world; how migration affects—and has been affected by—geography; and one of the biggest present problems related to geography: climate change. Because the course is self-paced, you may move through the material as quickly or as slowly as you need to, with the goal of demonstrating proficiency in the five competencies covered in the final assessment. If you have no prior knowledge of this material, you can expect to spend 30–40 hours on the course content.